had noted that the American anticommunist efforts that made India the most apprehensive were those directed against China.[86]

The approach Eisenhower and Dulles took focused on pressuring China. They had concluded that there were few near-term feasible options to get rid of the communist government in Beijing. Pressure, on the other hand, could facilitate internal instability. Isolating China would also strain Sino-Soviet relations since Beijing would depend more on and demand more of Moscow. Thus their strategy envisioned trade embargos, covert action, and psychological warfare, as well as refusing to recognize Mao's regime or support its bid to take the Chinese seat at the UN.[87]

Nehru told Indian heads of mission that this American approach to China was "unrealistic and fallacious."[88] He remained frustrated about the US reluctance to recognize the regime in Beijing.[89] Washington was leaving a "major factor out of reckoning. It is bound to upset the cart."[90] Nehru also worried about the consequences of the "obviously wrong" American effort to keep Taipei in and Beijing out of the UN Security Council, noting, "a whole castle is sought to be built on an artificial foundation; and then, if something goes wrong afterwards, complaint is made."[91] Furthermore, isolating rather than engaging Beijing only kept it more connected to Moscow.[92]

Asked during a congressional hearing in 1953 if he and Nehru agreed at all on China, Dulles had said no.[93] He had told the South Korean president that their key difference was on tactics—India believed "the methods of appeasement rather than strength would weaken the communist world."[94] There was little expectation that Delhi would change its approach. Nehru had told Dulles what he had told Truman: that India had to deal with China for reasons of geography and pragmatism—their countries shared a 2,000-mile boundary. And he did not want "trouble for the indefinite future," especially since the Indian leadership needed peace for nation-building.[95]

In the post-Stalin era, American analysts saw Beijing's willingness to come to the table for talks on Korea as only reinforcing Indian views that China did not intend to behave aggressively.[96] US policymakers knew that India wanted to establish a modus vivendi with the regime in Beijing. For that reason, an NSC assessment had predicted in early 1954, "India will go to great lengths to win Red China's friendship."[97] Indeed, India was doing just that at the time, with negotiations that would culminate in the signing